CCRUM TOWARDS VIKSIT BHARAT@2047

Advancing Evidence-Based Unani Medicine through Innovation, Research and Integrative Healthcare



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India's vision of Viksit Bharat@2047 envisages a nation that is not only economically strong and technologically advanced but also healthier, self-reliant, and globally respected for its knowledge systems. As healthcare evolves towards a preventive, personalized and integrative model, India's traditional systems of medicine are poised to play an increasingly important role in addressing emerging health challenges. Among these, the Unani System of Medicine, with its holistic philosophy, individualized approach and centuries-old clinical wisdom, offers immense potential to complement conventional healthcare in promoting wellness, preventing disease and managing illnesses.

The Central Council for Research in Unani Medicine (CCRUM), an autonomous organization under the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, has been at the forefront of translating this potential into scientific reality. Since its establishment in 1978, the Council has built a national network of 24 peripheral institutes dedicated to multidisciplinary research encompassing clinical, preclinical, fundamental, literary, drug standardization and medicinal plant research.

Today, the Council's vision extends beyond preserving traditional medical heritage. It seeks to position Unani medicine as a scientifically validated, globally recognized healthcare system capable of contributing meaningfully to national priorities and the objectives of the National Health Policy, 2017.

Expanding Access through Integrative Healthcare

As India progresses towards Viksit Bharat@2047, under the visionary leadership of Shri Narendra Modi Hon'ble Prime Minister, equitable access to quality healthcare remains a national priority. CCRUM has expanded the reach of evidence-based Unani medicine through its 24 peripheral institutes, which serve as centres for patient care, clinical research, education and public health. With a special focus on rural populations, urban slums and socially disadvantaged communities, the Council delivers healthcare through mobile OPDs, health camps, school health programmes and community outreach initiatives.

CCRUM has also strengthened the integration of Unani medicine with mainstream healthcare through multidisciplinary research and collaborations with premier scientific institutions, creating an evidence-based framework that combines traditional knowledge with biomedical sciences.

Building Scientific Credibility through Evidence-Based Research

Scientific validation remains the cornerstone of CCRUM's mission. Clinical research has generated evidence on the safety and efficacy of Unani interventions, particularly for chronic and lifestyle disorders, while preclinical research has established scientific evidence for numerous single drugs and compound formulations through pharmacological, toxicological and safety evaluations.

Strengthening Quality Assurance through Modern Infrastructure

To enhance quality, safety and global acceptance, CCRUM has strengthened its research and healthcare infrastructure. Several hospitals and laboratories have received NABH and NABL accreditation, while pharmacies at NRIUMSD, Hyderabad and RRIUM, Chennai have received GMP certification. Advanced In-Silico Drug Discovery Laboratories and state-of-the-art Preclinical Research Laboratories, equipped with modern technologies including AI-assisted computational tools, are further advancing drug discovery and scientific research.

Advancing Standards and Innovation

Standardization has been central to CCRUM's efforts to mainstream Unani medicine through pharmacopoeial standards, Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and Standard Treatment Guidelines (STGs). Evidence-based STGs for Musculoskeletal and Metabolic Disorders have been developed, while STGs for Dermatological Disorders are under publication by Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS).

The Council has also published SOPs for Hijāma (Cupping Therapy) and other regimens under Ilāj bi'l Tadbīr, reinforcing safe and uniform clinical practice. A standardized Mizāj (Temperament) Assessment Tool, developed through expert consultations, validation and pilot testing, is now ready for multicentric validation studies.

Innovation Driving the Future of Unani Medicine

Innovation has become a defining feature of CCRUM's research strategy. The Council has secured 19 patents, while additional patent applications have received approvals from the National Biodiversity Authority. Recent provisional patents cover novel Unani formulations for glaucoma management, hepatoprotective and antioxidant therapies, and herbal vaginal insertable capsule compositions.

Digital Transformation and Global Collaboration

Digital transformation is a key pillar in the modernization of Unani healthcare. The implementation of the Ayush Hospital Management Information System (A-HMIS) and NAMASTE Portal across peripheral institutes has streamlined patient care, hospital management and health data generation. Mobile and web-based applications covering single drugs, compound formulations, treatment guidelines, Mizāj assessment, common remedies and Unani Aahar are also empowering practitioners, students, researchers and the public with reliable information.

At the global level, CCRUM is positioning India as a leader in evidence-based traditional medicine through international collaborations with academic and research institutions in Bangladesh, Tajikistan,



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South Africa, Iran and the UAE. Through the Ministry of Ayush, the Council has also contributed to WHO initiatives related to global benchmarks for Unani training and practice, international Unani terminologies, integration of AYUSH morbidity codes into ICD-11 and the ongoing development of traditional medicine intervention code sets for the International Classification of Health Interventions (ICHI).

Promoting Healthy Living & Nurturing Future Unani Researchers

CCRUM is advancing preventive healthcare through Unani Aahar products, including Qahwa, Hareera and barley-based foods, while strengthening research and commercialization. Simultaneously, it is nurturing the next generation of Unani researchers through M.D., Ph.D., UG-SPUR and PG-SPUR programmes, fostering scientific aptitude, research capacity and evidence-based advancement of Unani medicine.

As India moves towards Viksit Bharat@2047, CCRUM remains committed to building a future where Unani medicine contributes meaningfully to universal health coverage, preventive healthcare and global health. By bridging tradition with technology and research with clinical practice, the Council is positioning Unani medicine as a scientifically validated and globally relevant healthcare system for the twenty-first century.